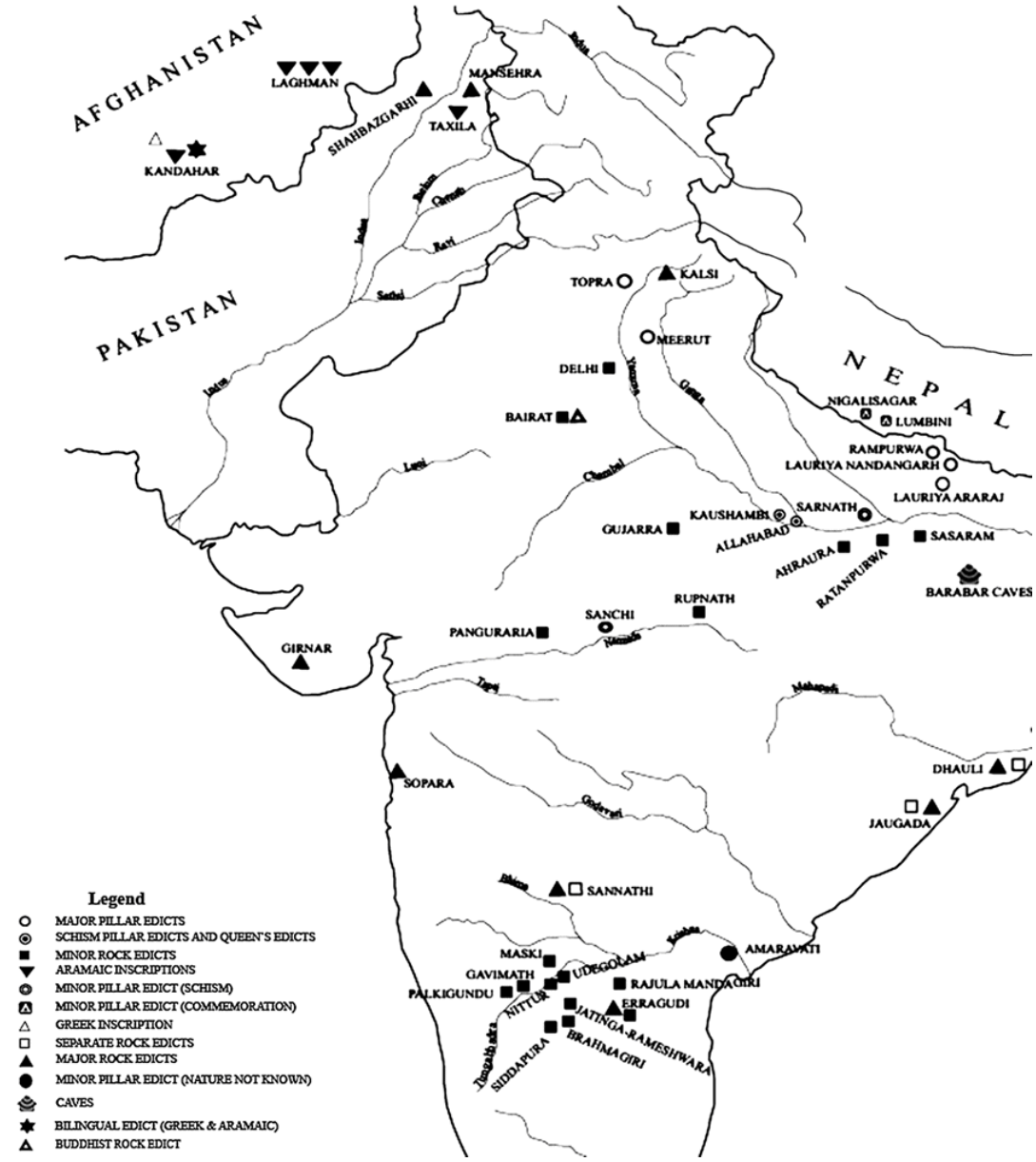


Map 1: Distribution of the Epigraphs of Ashoka

Some 2200 years ago this political figure made himself visible through the words that he caused to be inscribed at Erragudi as well as at scores of other places across India and beyond.

Ashoka's inscriptions represent a kind of historical daybreak, ending a long phase of faceless rulers. In approximately 600 BCE, kings emerged out of the realms of tradition to set up and rule over several kingdoms stretching from the highlands of the north-west frontier to the lowlands of